

Sexting

Sexting, also known as nude selfies or nudes, is when people send naked, underwear-only, or sexually explicit pictures or videos of themselves or a part of their body. There are many risks involved, even if the sext doesn't include a person's face.

Why people might sext

Someone might send a sexy text, or "sext," to feel closer to their partner or because they think it's fun and flirty. If two people are happy and comfortable in their relationship, sexting is okay; however, it can still be risky.

Even if a teen trusts the person they are sexting with, if they aren't comfortable with sexting, they should feel confident enough to say no. It may seem, or people might say, that everybody else is sexting, but they aren't. If a person feels pressured or coerced by someone else to take a sext, that's not okay, and it's likely to be a sign of an unhealthy relationship. Some people may also send sexts to get someone's attention, to impress a person, or to make someone like them, but this rarely works and is more likely to put the person off them.

When sending a sext, teens should always have the consent of the other person first, as they may feel very uncomfortable about receiving an explicit image. If they say no, it's essential to respect the other person's answer.



△ Think about it beforehand

Not everyone feels comfortable with sending or receiving sexts, and nobody should be pressured to do so.

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The risks

When a person sends a sext, it is no longer possible for them to control who sees it, no matter how much they trust the recipient of the sext. An image can be shared very quickly among a wide network of people without permission, and even posted online. When deciding whether or not to sext, it's essential to consider the risks:

Even following a good relationship, a person might share it after a breakup.

It might fall into the wrong hands, even accidentally.

A sext may eventually be seen by a person's teachers, parents, grandparents, siblings, or friends.

The recipient may not be trustworthy and could share the image with friends.

It may damage the sender's reputation and possibly affect future prospects.

People might share the image to bully, shame, or blackmail a person.

If a person is under 18 years old, taking an explicit picture of themselves is illegal, as is sharing it.